$8.86 million for one, becoming Cray Research's first official customer. This Cray model is also referred to as the first commercially successful vector processor, also known as array processor; it could simultaneously run multiple mathematical operations on multiple data elements.


Supercomputing became commercial with the Cray-1

Diffie-Hellman
A cryptographic protocol allows establishing a shared secret key over an unprotected channel amongst two parties that don't have any information about each other. It is commonly known as the Diffie-Hellman key exchange. Since no authentication is provided to either of the parties, it was insecure as any person could break in—so a password-authenticated key agreement form of Diffie-Hellman was also being used. A year later, in 1977, RSA algorithm followed the same method, another implementation of public-key cryptography using asymmetric algorithms.

1977: Modems And Oracle And Unix

May—August: BSD
An operating system considered as a branch of UNIX was developed at University of California, Berkeley. It was distributed with the name of "Berkeley Software Distribution" (BSD), and pioneered many of the advances of modern computing. Researchers at universities used the source code included in UNIX from The Bell Labs to modify and extend UNIX. Since many universities were interested in software, Bill Joy, a graduate student at Berkeley, assembled and distributed tapes of first Berkeley Software Distribution. Joy went on to become Sun's CEO in the 1990s.